

Spanish galleon



Spanish invasion

In the 16th century, Spanish explorers came to the Americas. Their arrival meant the end of the Aztec, Maya, and Inca empires. Many people were killed and their cities destroyed.

Mayan cities

The Maya built great cities, filled with magnificent stone temples, palaces, and squares. This is the Temple of the Great Jaguar in the Mayan city of Tikal.

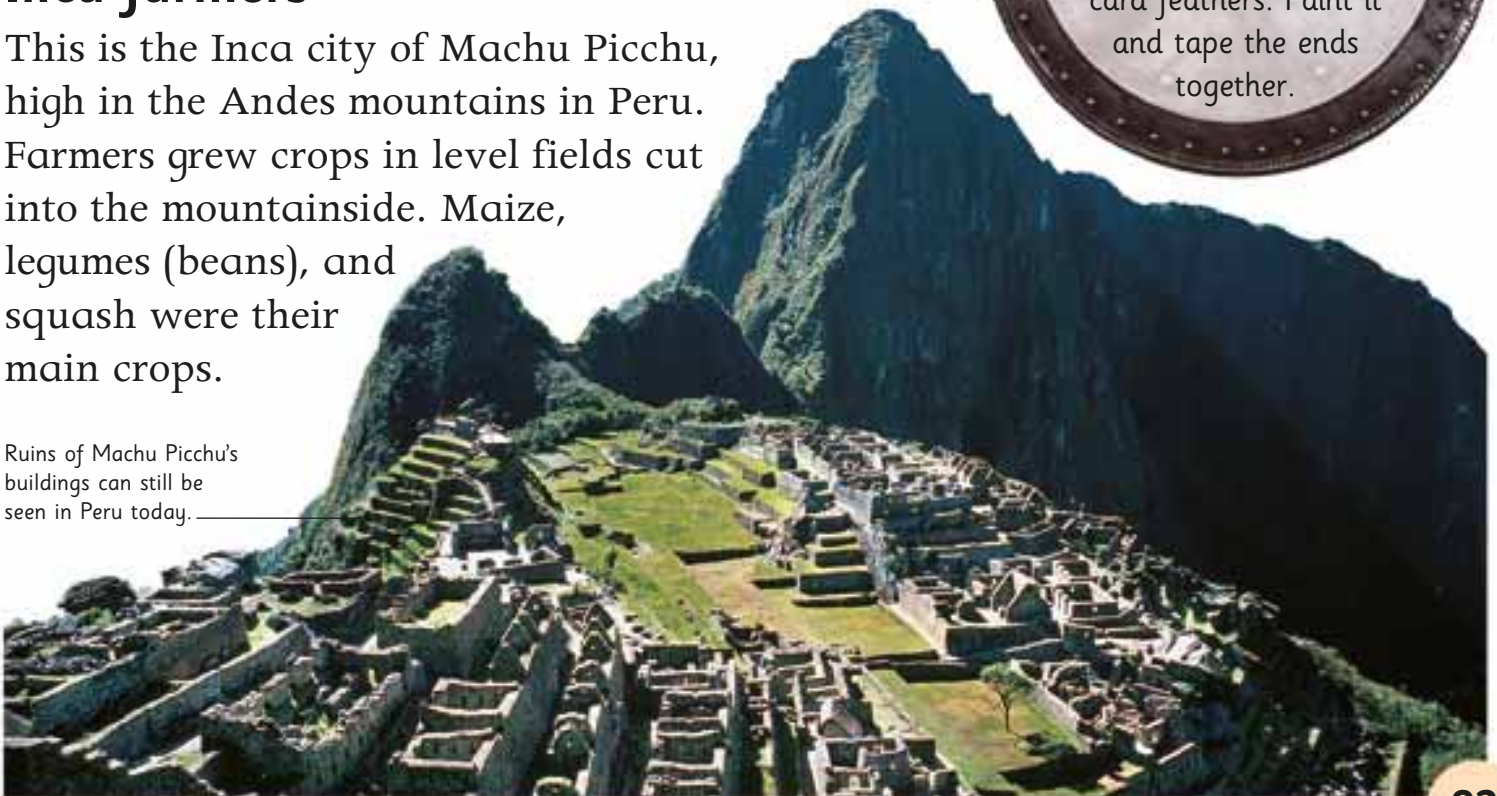


Tikal is in Guatemala, South America.

Inca farmers

This is the Inca city of Machu Picchu, high in the Andes mountains in Peru. Farmers grew crops in level fields cut into the mountainside. Maize, legumes (beans), and squash were their main crops.

Ruins of Machu Picchu's buildings can still be seen in Peru today.



Inca gold

The Incas made objects from gold. The Spanish greed for gold led to the end of the Inca empire.



Llamas were important to the Incas. They were used for wool and for transport.



Gold armbands may have been worn by the bravest Inca warriors.



Statues of Inca gods were made from gold to show honour towards them.

Hands on

Make an Aztec headdress. Cut a strip of card to go round your head and stick on card feathers. Paint it and tape the ends together.